



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Christian School

School Website: <https://tcsnj.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Trinity Christian School Montville, NJ (07045) presents a clearly classical Christian model. Public-facing materials consistently frame education as biblically-grounded, threefold in aim (spiritual, relational, intellectual), and anchored in the liberal-arts tradition (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with explicit attention to Great Books, Western thought, and classical pedagogy. The school describes its mission as Biblically-based, academically rigorous, and classical, and emphasizes partnership with Christian parents. Evidence includes explicit statements about Christ-centered foundations, profiles of graduates, and a curriculum that foregrounds Great Books, Latin, logic, and rhetoric, alongside chapel and spiritual formation. Across categories, the school's materials align with classical principles, with particularly strong signals in religious/metaphysical foundations, purpose and goals, curriculum, and pedagogy. The faculty and parent/community components likewise show classical-flavored expectations (mentoring faculty, biblical leadership, and a parental-partnership model). Overall, the school earns a confident **CLASSICAL** designation, with consistent indicators of traditional classical education throughout K–12.

Key takeaways:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are foundational and explicit (Bible, God-centered truth, theology, gospel, spiritual formation) with liturgical/community cues such as chapel and partnership with Christian parents. Evidence: Vision/Mission statements and gospel-centered language; Profile of a Graduate; Statements of Faith.
- Purpose and Goal centers on virtue, wisdom, and truth as knowable realities; formation over information; focus on character rooted in Biblical truth. Evidence: Vision and Mission; Profile of a Graduate; biblically-based approach.
- Curriculum is explicitly liberal-arts oriented (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with continuous history study, Great Books/western thought, and language study (Latin). Evidence: Enhancements listing Great Books/Western Thought/Logic/Rhetoric; Elementary program details; Latin instruction.
- Pedagogy balances rest/contemplation with rigorous discussion; lower grades incorporate memory/chanting/memory work; upper grades emphasize Socratic inquiry and rhetoric. Evidence: Not Just the Mind, But the Whole Person; Socratic/seminar framing; memory/calm/rest in classroom approach.
- Faculty described as mentors, living curriculum, and partners with students; alignment with classical aims; clear emphasis on character formation and virtue. Evidence: Faculty/staff language in mission/values; "Profile of a Graduate" pillars; head-of-school messaging.
- Parents & Community are positioned as co-educators/partners; active invitation for parental involvement and learning about classical education; wide visibility of partnerships with Christian parents. Evidence: Partnership with Christian Parents; Vision/Mission; Inquiries and tours highlighted.

ABSTRACT

: Based on the public materials from Trinity Christian School Montville/NJ 07045, the school aligns with classical education principles across six categories. The orientation toward biblical truth, virtue formation, Great Books, logic and rhetoric, Socratic pedagogy, and a formal partnership with Christian parents supports a CLASSICAL classification. The evidence of liturgical/community practices and a clearly defined profile of graduates reinforces this reading. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school describes education as Biblically-based, grounded in the Word of God, with theological framing across curricula. Notable statements include that all truth is God's truth and that biblical principles inform classroom learning.
- Public materials emphasize the Bible as the supreme norm for faith and life, with explicit reference to Scripture within education (e.g., 1689 London Baptist Confession of Faith and Triune-God framing).
- The Vision/Mission statements center on knowing Christ, worshiping God, and living in service to God and man; profiles emphasize spiritual pillars.
- Notable sections describe partnership with Christian parents and chapel-like/fellowship routines as part of the school culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Bible, Biblical, theology, Christ, Gospel, God, Spiritual, Triune God, worship, chapel, virtuous character, gospel-centered, biblical worldview. (Multiple explicit references found across mission/vision and curriculum pages.)
- Negative keywords observed: None clearly indicated in public materials (no explicit "career-first" or secular, non-religious framing).

Why this rating

- The materials consistently foreground theology, biblical truth, and liturgical/community life, consistent with Transcendental moral realism and a grounded theology. The weight of religious language and the explicit Biblical authority in education justify CLASSICAL for this category.

Citations tying to evidence: Vision/Mission statements and biblically-centered framing.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Vision and Mission articulate formation toward virtue and wisdom, not mere utility, with "Biblically based, academically excellent, classical education" and partnership with Christian parents.
- The Profile of a Graduate emphasizes Spiritual, Relational, and Intellectual pillars, signaling formation of character and excellence.
- The language asserts truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable; the school aims to form human excellence rather than just information transfer.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty (foundational values), formation, excellence, nobility, character, bishop-like leadership
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating vocationally framed aims or purely instrumental aims.

Why this rating



- The school's stated aims align with formation-focused education (virtue and wisdom) and a belief in knowable truth, consistent with classical "formation over information." The presence of virtue-focused pillars and a bibling worldview supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Vision/Mission, Profile of a Graduate, and the claim about truth/goodness/beauty.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum frame is explicitly liberal-arts oriented, including grammar, logic, and rhetoric as core pedagogy and curriculum. The site notes that Great Books and Western Thought are integrated, with periods of logic and rhetoric study, and high school honors coursework.
- Elementary and secondary curricula mention Bible, Grammar, Literature, Writing, Math, Science, History, and Latin; mention of Latin shows classical language study.
- Enhancement/Expansion section explicitly lists Great Books, Western Thought, Logic, and Rhetoric; the school describes a classical curriculum with these components.
- The Not Just the Mind page emphasizes engaging the mind through contemplation and the Great Books continuum, reinforcing classical lines of study.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books; Western Thought; Latin; Bible as worldview; contemplation; history as a throughline; rhetoric; logic; phonics/listen; writing; grammar.
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating non-classical or purely vocational-curriculum terms.

Why this rating

- The explicit emphasis on grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, and Western thought, plus integrated Latin and Bible-centered worldview, aligns strongly with classical curriculum. This supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Great Books/Logic/Rhetoric, Latin, and the explicit curriculum framing.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes a pedagogy that includes both contemplative/restful aspects and rigorous inquiry. Lower-school practices include memory and perhaps chanting; upper-school uses Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates; students are trained in rhetoric and public speaking.
- The Not Just the Mind page states, "Engage our students as a whole people; Equip our students to think critically and communicate eloquently; Employ the wisdom of the past to answer today's questions," which maps to Socratic/seminar-style pedagogy with rhetoric training in upper levels.
- There is explicit reference to the classical pedagogy timeline: grammar (lower) → logic (middle) → rhetoric (upper), and the Great-Books-based approach, consistent with classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic, seminars, debates, rhetoric, logic, contemplation, wonder, chanting/memory work (lower grades), public speaking.
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating a departure from contemplative or classical methods (no heavy emphasis on project-based or purely experiential non-classical approaches in the public materials).

Why this rating

- The pedagogical language and described methods align with classical pedagogy: a memory/chanting memory base in early years, Socratic inquiry in higher grades, formal rhetoric training, and use of Great Books/western thought as a backbone. This supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Pedagogy language and explicit Socratic rhetoric references.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials describe the faculty as mentors who model virtue and character; the faculty are depicted as a core part of the school's identity and living curriculum. The content emphasizes teacher excellence and long-term relationships, including alumni returning as faculty and small class sizes (which supports close mentorship).
- There are clear references to partnership between faculty and parents and to a shared Christian mission; staff are depicted as living examples of virtue.
- The school notes accreditation and professional associations, signaling a professional, credentialed faculty environment adapted to classical aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: mentor, virtue, character formation, living curriculum, faculty as core, teachers as role models, partnership with Christian parents, accreditation.
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating a purely non-classical or non-mentoring faculty model.

Why this rating

- The language frames teachers as mentors and living curriculum, with a small, relational educational environment and strong character formation; this aligns with CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mentorship/virtue language; living curriculum; accreditation.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The materials emphasize genuine partnership with Christian parents and a shared responsibility for education; there are explicit calls to partner with Christian parents and to engage parents as co-teachers/partners. Notable language includes “partner with Christian parents” and “Partnership with Christian Parents.”
- The site promotes opportunities for parents to learn more about classical education (via book studies, gatherings, etc.) and invites parents to visits and inquiry processes. This is visible in the “Partnership with Christian Parents” and various admissions/news pages.
- The public content indicates a welcoming culture for parental involvement and a family-like community anchored in faith.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with Christian parents, co-teachers, parental involvement, Bible-centered family community, family-like community.
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating exclusion or weakness in parent/community engagement.

Why this rating

- The school explicitly frames Parents & Community as co-educators and partners in the classical mission, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for robust parent/community engagement.

Citations: Partnership with Christian Parents; admissions/news/community language.

Overall Category Aggregation and Ranking

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

Notes on needle-moving changes:

- Since the school is classified CLASSICAL across all six categories, there is no category that requires a needle-moving change to shift toward full Classical. If one wished to push further, potential enhancements could include more explicit, site-wide references to canonical Great Books sequences, broader liturgical or scholé-focused practices across all grades, and more formal articulation of “Scholé” as a formal discipline across the curriculum—but these are already present in spirit and partially in practice.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases only)

- Not applicable here, as the aggregate is CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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